

# THE DO'S OF PRESENTING

## PRACTICE MAKES PERFECT



Practice, practice, practice! Whether it is on your own or in front of family or friends, run through your presentation a good few times.

## INTRODUCE YOURSELF

At the very start of your presentation, make sure you introduce yourself confidently to your audience.



## EYE CONTACT

Maintain eye contact with the audience to keep their interest. Keep your posture open and spread out.



## USE PROPS



Use props, handouts and videos to make your presentation more exciting.

## ASK QUESTIONS

Always ask if the audience has any questions at the end, as this will help to get them involved.




THE DON'TS OF PRESENTING
TALK TOO FAST OR SLOW
Keep your talking to a steady speed, to ensure the audience hears and takes in everything you say whilst not getting bored.
READ FROM YOUR SLIDES
Reading from your slides makes you look unprepared and unprofessional. Have some cue cards to refer to but try to keep eye contact with the audience.
PACE AROUND
Try not to pace up and down because you are nervous, as this will most likely distract and annoy your audience.
SAY 'UM'
Rather than saying 'um' within a sentence, practice pausing and thinking in your head instead.
FIDGET WITH HANDS
Try your best not to fidget with your hands. Try having them by your sides, or holding onto a cue card to keep them still.

# COMMUNICATE YOUR MESSAGE



There are three elements of face to face communication - words, tone of voice, and body language.

The three elements need to support each other for effective communication. If they do not, words are the least important of the three.



7%

of an overall message is communicated with words (what is actually said).



38%

of an overall message is communicated through tone of voice.



55%

of an overall message is communicated through body language.

*"In Latin, 'Omne Trium Perfectum' means every set of three is complete"*

- Ethos3, Presentation Designer Agency

# KEEP THEIR ATTENTION



**12s**

is the average attention span (in seconds) of humans in 2000.

On average, our attention span has decreased quite considerably. This is relevant when it comes to presenting, as you need to ensure you grab the attention of your audience and maintain that attention.

**8s**

is the average attention span of humans in 2016.

**9s**

is the average attention span of a gold fish.

"The optimal attention span for an audience, i.e the attention span that can be comfortably held by an interested human engaged in listening to a speaker, is not five to ten minutes.

***Instead, it is approximately twenty (20) minutes."***

- Alf Rehn, Professor of Management, Speaker and Writer